

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

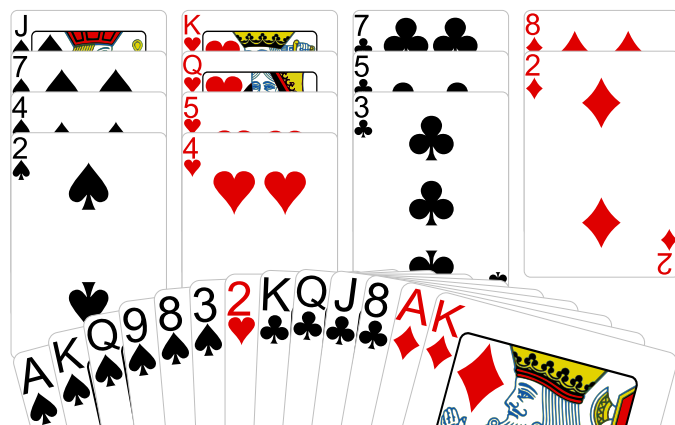
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

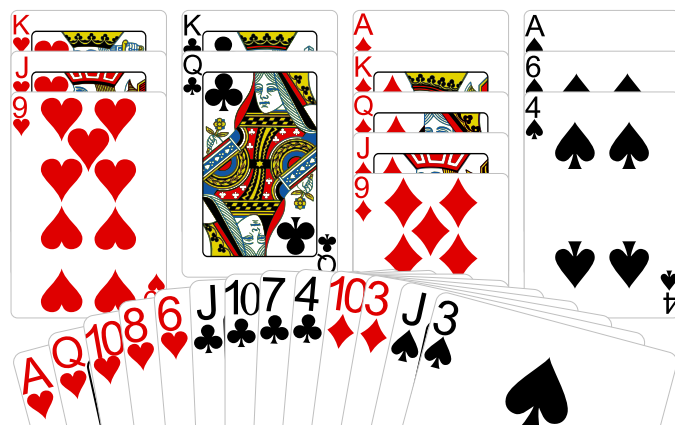
BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Deal 1 Ctr: 5♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



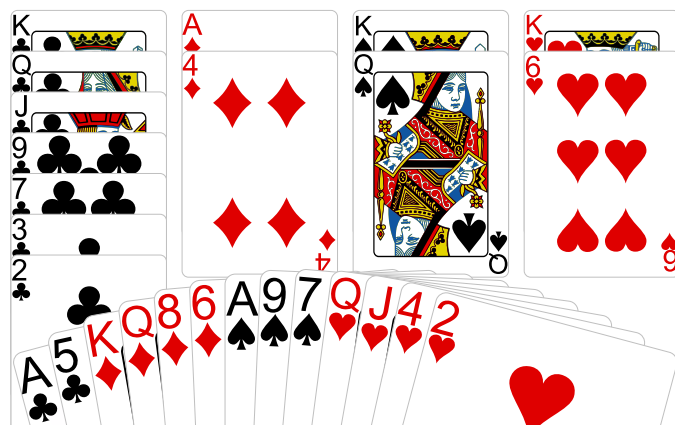
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 7NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 5♠
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 7NT
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 5♥
Declarer: North

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T
♥ A T 8 3
♦ 7 6 5 4 3
♣ A 9 6

22
8 4
6

♠ A K Q 9 8 3
♥ 2
♦ A K
♣ K Q J 8



♠ J 7 4 2
♥ K Q 5 4
♦ 8 2
♣ 7 5 3

♠ 6 5
♥ J 9 7 6
♦ Q J T 9
♣ T 4 2

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			
5♠ by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 1

SOUTH's 3♠ supporting bid is enough to convince NORTH to make a slam try.

NORTH bids Blackwood 4NT. If SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH plans to bid 6♠, but

when SOUTH bids 5♣ NORTH settles for 5♠

Deal 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 6 4
 ♥ K J 9
 ♦ A K Q J 9
 ♣ K Q

4
 23 8
 5

♠ T 8 2
 ♥ 7 5 4 2
 ♦ 6 4
 ♣ A 6 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 9 7 5
 ♥ 3
 ♦ 8 7 5 2
 ♣ 9 8 5

♠ J 3
 ♥ A Q T 8 6
 ♦ T 3
 ♣ J T 7 4

West

2♣

4NT

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by East

North

Pass

Pass

East

2♥

5♦

South

Pass

Pass

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 2

EAST makes a positive 3

♥

response to WEST's 2♣ opener.

This promises at least 8 points and a 5-card suit with two or more honors.

WEST only needs to know one thing - how many Aces in the EAST hand.

A Blackwood 4NT tells her the answer is one, so she bids 6

♥

.

Deal 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 8 3 2

♥ T 7 3

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ 6 4

18

2 4

16

♠ K Q

♥ K 6

♦ A 4

♣ K Q J 9 7 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 9 7

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ K Q 8 6

♣ A 5

♠ T 6 5 4

♥ A 9 8 5

♦ T 7 5

♣ T 8

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 3

When SOUTH opens 1NT, point-count alone tells NORTH that 6NT can surely be made.

SOUTH is bound to hold at least two Aces. But NORTH doesn't want to miss a Grand slam.

NORTH bids 4♣, (Gerber), and SOUTH admits to just two Aces.

So NORTH settles for the small slam.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			

Deal 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K Q 6 4 3
 ♥ K 5
 ♦ K 7 3
 ♣ A K

4
 22 12
 2

♠ T 7
 ♥ Q T 2
 ♦ J 6 5 2
 ♣ J 6 4 3

N
 W E
 S

♠ 8
 ♥ 9 8 6
 ♦ T 9 8 4
 ♣ Q T 7 5 2

♠ J 9 5 2
 ♥ A J 7 4 3
 ♦ A Q
 ♣ 9 8

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♥	Pass
7NT			
All Pass			
7NT by West			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 4

WEST has a powerhouse and knows she will reach a slam somewhere. When EAST

supports the ♠s, it seems she has found her spot.

Blackwood tells her that EAST has two Aces.

She can see there are 12 tricks available and decides to take a chance that

EAST will have a thirteenth trick somewhere among his opening hand points.

She bids 7NT.

Deal 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 8 6
 ♥ 7 2
 ♦ 5 4
 ♣ A 9 4 3 2

8
 6 4
 22

♠ J 7 3
 ♥ A J T 9 8
 ♦ 8 3 2
 ♣ Q 8



♠ A K 2
 ♥ K Q 6 5
 ♦ K Q J
 ♣ K J 6

♠ T 5 4
 ♥ 4 3
 ♦ A T 9 7 6
 ♣ T 7 5

Baker Bidpractice/Set 7 5

SOUTH is tempted to go right to 6



when she hears NORTH's positive

response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because NORTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.

West	North	East	South
			2 ♣
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	5 ♥
All Pass			
5 ♥ by North			

Deal 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 4
 ♥ A 8
 ♦ K Q J T 7 3
 ♣ K 5

6
 18 13
 3

♠ T 9 7
 ♥ Q 6 5 3
 ♦ 8 5 2
 ♣ A 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 8 5 2
 ♥ J 9 4 2
 ♦ 6
 ♣ J T 6 2

♠ A 6 3
 ♥ K T 7
 ♦ A 9 4
 ♣ Q 9 8 7

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
4 ♣	Pass	4 ♠	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			
6NT by East			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 6

WEST not only has 20 points, he also has a lot of winners.

So when EAST jumps to 2NT, showing 13-15 points, WEST uses Gerber.

EAST shows two Aces so WEST decides 6NT will be just right.